Deliverable 06 – User Manual and Quick Reference: Instructor Consultation Booking System

Author: Md Alamgir Hossain · October 2026 · *Illustrative case study: Walter Dvorak is the course instructor who acted as stakeholder. The interview answers and all figures here are illustrative examples prepared by the student team, not his actual statements.*

This guide shows students how to book, change and cancel a consultation, and shows the instructor how to manage availability, meetings and notes. It is the user documentation for the GUI prototype (Deliverable 08), following the user documentation guidance in Chapter 11.

1. Getting started

Who this guide is for: students and project groups booking consultations, and the instructor managing them. No technical knowledge is needed.

What you need: a college account and a web browser on a phone, tablet or computer.

Sign in

1. Open the booking link from your course page in D2L Brightspace.
2. Select **Sign in with college account**.
3. Enter your college email and password. You stay signed in on that device until you sign out.

Screen map

Screen	Who uses it	What it is for
S1 Booking calendar	Student	See open time slots
S2 Booking form	Student	Enter details and confirm a booking
S3 My bookings	Student	See, reschedule or cancel your bookings
S4 Instructor dashboard	Instructor	See today's and this week's meetings
S5 Availability settings	Instructor	Set office hours, slot lengths and blocked dates
S6 Meeting notes and history	Instructor	Add notes, search past meetings
S7 Reports	Instructor	Monthly summary and no-show report

2. Student guide

Book a meeting (S1 → S2)

1. On the **Booking calendar**, use the **<** and **>** arrows to choose a week.
2. Open slots are shown in colour; booked or past slots are greyed out and cannot be selected.
3. Select an open slot, then select **Book this slot**.

4. On the **Booking form**, choose the meeting type: **Individual (15 min)** or **Group (30 min)**.
5. For a group meeting, enter your group name.
6. Choose **In person** or **Online (Teams)**.
7. Type a short topic (up to 200 characters), e.g. “the case study feedback”.
8. Select **Confirm booking**. A confirmation message appears, and a confirmation email arrives within 1 minute.

Reschedule or cancel (S3)

1. Select **My bookings** at the top of any screen.
2. Find the meeting and select **Reschedule** or **Cancel booking**.
3. To reschedule, pick a new open slot and select **Confirm**.
4. You can change or cancel up to **2 hours** before the meeting. After that, email the instructor.

Reminders

- You get a reminder email **24 hours** before every meeting.
- Online meetings include a **Join Teams meeting** link in the confirmation and the reminder.

3. Instructor guide

Set your availability (S5)

1. Select **Availability** in the top menu.
2. Under **Office hours**, choose the days and times (default: Tuesday and Thursday, 1–3 pm).
3. Set the **Slot length** for individual (15 min) and group (30 min) meetings.
4. Under **Blocked dates**, add any days you are unavailable (e.g., reading week).
5. Select **Save**. Changes show on the students’ booking calendar immediately.

Use the dashboard (S4)

- **Today** lists your meetings in time order, with the student or group name, topic and location or Teams link.
- **Rest of the week** shows upcoming days and open slots.
- Meetings also appear in your Outlook calendar within 5 minutes.

Add notes and mark status (S6)

1. Select **Open notes** on a meeting in the dashboard, or open **Notes and history** in the top menu.
2. Type your notes in the **Private notes** box. Only you can see them.
3. Select a status: **Held**, **Cancelled** or **No-show**.
4. Select **Save notes**.
5. To find past meetings, use **Search** or **Filter by group**.

View reports (S7)

1. Select **Reports**.
2. Choose **Monthly summary** (meetings held, cancellations, no-shows) or **No-show report** (only meetings marked as no-show).
3. Select **Export** to download as Excel or PDF.

4. Quick reference card

Print or pin this one-page summary.

I want to...	Go to	Do this
Book a meeting	Booking calendar	Pick an open slot → **Book this slot** → fill in form → **Confirm booking**
Book a group meeting	Booking form	Choose **Group (30 min)** and enter the group name
Change a meeting	My bookings	**Reschedule** → pick a new slot → **Confirm** (up to 2 h before)
Cancel a meeting	My bookings	**Cancel booking** (up to 2 h before)
Join an online meeting	Confirmation or reminder email	Select **Join Teams meeting**
Set office hours (instructor)	Availability tab	Set days, times, slot length → **Save**
Record notes (instructor)	Dashboard → meeting	Type notes → choose status → **Save notes**
See reports (instructor)	Reports	Choose report → **Export**

5. FAQ and troubleshooting

Frequently asked questions

Question	Answer
Why can’t I select some slots?	Grey slots are already booked, in the past, or on a blocked date.
How many meetings can I book?	There is no limit in this version, but please book only what you need.
Can my whole group come?	Yes. Book a **Group (30 min)** meeting and enter your group name.
Will other students see my booking?	No. Students see only their own bookings.
Who can read the meeting notes?	Only the instructor.
I didn’t get a confirmation email.	Check your junk folder, then check **My bookings**. If the meeting is listed, it is booked.

Error messages

Message	What it means	What to do
“This slot is no longer available.”	Someone else booked it a moment before you.	Pick another open slot.
“Please enter a topic.”	The topic box is empty.	Type a short topic, then select **Confirm booking**.
“Changes are closed for this meeting.”	The meeting starts in less than 2 hours.	Email the instructor directly.
“Sign-in failed.”	Your college login was not accepted.	Check your email and password, or contact the IT Service Desk.

Support

- Booking questions: email Walter Dvorak (instructor) through your college account
- Sign-in or account problems: the college IT Service Desk (see the college’s IT support page)